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## 3. Place Introductions with SEO Hashtags

*History, culture and hashtags for each stop*

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*Stations, travel legs and hotels are excluded. Each place has an eye-catching title and SEO hashtags.*

### Where Kota Meets the River

*Kota, evening of Day 2*

We started our Kota evening on the riverbank. The palace stands on the Chambal, and a barrage was built next to it in 1960. The river is why this city exists, so seeing it first sets up the rest of the trip.

**#KotaRiverfront #ChambalRiver #Kota #RajasthanTravel #kuhook**

### Kota Museum: A Royal Life in Silver and Paint

*Kota, Day 3*

The museum has been open since 1970 and holds arms, royal regalia, textiles, miniatures and wall paintings inside the Garh Palace complex. It is the best place to understand Kota's royal collections.

**#KotaMuseum #RaoMadhoSinghMuseum #KotaPainting #MuseumsOfIndia #kuhook**

### Kota Fort: Elephants, Mirrors and Hunting Scenes

*Kota, Day 3 (starred in our plan)*

This was the highlight we starred in our plan: a fortified palace in the heart of the city. Its oldest parts date to 1624, the time of Rao Madho Singh, and it grew with later rulers.

**#KotaFort #GarhPalace #RajputArchitecture #HeritageIndia #kuhook**

### Gepernath: A Waterfall Over a Shiva Lingam

*Near Kota, Day 3*

A natural stream runs over the Shiva lingam in a gorge shrine, protected by the ASI since 1961. In the rains, police stop visitors from going down to the stream bed. That matched our experience: we couldn't get close to the shrine.

**#Gepernath #GeparnathMahadev #KotaWaterfall #ShivaTemple #MonsoonTravel #kuhook**

### The Baroli Temples: Stone Poetry of the Pratiharas

*Rawatbhata, Day 3*

Eight temples stand in a walled enclosure and a ninth about a kilometre away, all in the tenth-century Gurjara-Pratihara style. They stand on high ground by the Chambal's eastern bank, around a natural spring.

**#BaroliTemples #BadoliTemples #Rawatbhata #PratiharaArchitecture #HiddenGemsRajasthan #kuhook**

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## Rana Pratap Sagar Dam: Power from the Chambal

Rawatbhata, Day 3

This 53.8 m masonry dam was begun in 1953 and generates 172 MW. It is the second of four projects on the Chambal, named for Maharana Pratap and inaugurated in February 1970.

[#RanaPratapSagar](#) [#ChambalValley](#) [#Rawatbhata](#) [#DamTourism](#) [#kuhook](#)

## Chuliya Falls: The Monsoon's Best Show

Gandhisagar side, Day 4

These falls, formed by the Chambal near Rawatbhata, are known for their rock formations and quiet setting. They are fullest from July to September, so early September is a good time.

[#ChuliyaWaterfall](#) [#WaterfallsOfRajasthan](#) [#MonsoonTravel](#) [#Chambal](#) [#kuhook](#)

## Padajhar Waterfall: Green Pools on the Chambal

Gandhisagar side, Day 4

Padajhar lies on the Chambal's banks near Rawatbhata. It isn't large, but it is loved for its greenery and pools.

[#PadajharWaterfall](#) [#RajasthanWaterfalls](#) [#Rawatbhata](#) [#OffbeatIndia](#) [#kuhook](#)

## Gandhi Sagar Dam: A Landmark of New India

Gandhisagar, Day 4

Nehru laid the foundation stone in March 1954, and the 62.17 m dam was finished in 1960. It belongs to the early years of independent India's Chambal Valley project.

[#GandhiSagarDam](#) [#Mandsaur](#) [#MadhyaPradeshTourism](#) [#ChambalValleyProject](#) [#kuhook](#)

## Chambal Sunset Point: Golden Hour on the Reservoir

Gandhisagar, Day 4

We watched the light fade over the backwaters. The area is known for cliffs where vultures and cliff swallows nest, and for boat safaris on the Chambal.

[#ChambalSunset](#) [#GandhiSagar](#) [#SunsetPoints](#) [#MadhyaPradesh](#) [#kuhook](#)

## Dharmrajeshwar: A Temple Carved Down Into the Hill

Chandwasa, Day 4

The most memorable stop of the trip. This 8th-century rock-cut temple began as a Vishnu shrine and later became a Shiva temple, which is why the sanctum holds both a Harihara image and a lingam.

[#Dharmarajeshwar](#) [#Dhamnar](#) [#RockCutTemple](#) [#HiddenIndia](#) [#MadhyaPradeshHeritage](#)  
[#Chandwasa](#) [#kuhook](#)

## Holkar Chhatri: A Memorial to a Maratha Warrior

Bhanpura, Day 5

Yashwant Rao Holkar died in Bhanpura on 28 October 1811. A chhatri was raised on the spot between 1814 and 1841. He fought the British in the Second Anglo-Maratha War and later made peace with them.

[#HolkarChhatri](#) [#YashwantraoHolkar](#) [#Bhanpura](#) [#MarathaHistory](#) [#MadhyaPradeshHeritage](#)  
[#kuhook](#)

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## **Bade Mahadev: A Waterfall Shrine Near Bhanpura**

*Bhanpura, Day 5*

A pilgrimage spot near the town, known for its waterfall. One local account describes a fall of about 70 m; I'd check that on site.

**#BadeMahadev #Bhanpura #ShivaTemple #HiddenWaterfalls #kuhook**

## **"Mini Goa" at Gandhi Sagar: Beach Vibes on the Chambal**

*Gandhi Sagar, Day 5*

A local nickname for the lakeshore, not an official name. The Gandhisagar Forest Retreat, run by Madhya Pradesh Tourism on the Chambal backwaters, has tented stays and adventure activities.

**#MiniGoa #GandhiSagar #LakeTourism #MadhyaPradeshTourism #kuhook**

## **Kakuni: Ruined Temples With a Story**

*Kakuni, Day 5*

The temples are said to date from the 8th century, with remains of Vaishnava, Shaiva and Jain shrines. About 60% of the sculptures are now in the museums at Kota and Jhalawar, a good reason to visit Kota first.

**#KakuniTemples #BaranRajasthan #AncientIndia #OffbeatRajasthan #kuhook**